Mini Project: Inclusive UI Design

Project: AI-Powered Travel Planner
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Track: UI/UX Design
Screen Evaluated: AI-Generated Itinerary

Objective

The goal of this project is to evaluate and redesign a key screen in the AI-powered Travel Planner app through the lens of inclusive and accessible design. The aim is to ensure usability for a wide range of users, regardless of ability, age, or background, while aligning with WCAG accessibility standards and empathy-driven design.

1. Understanding Inclusive Design & Accessibility Needs

User Groups Considered

User Group	Accessibility Challenges
1. Visually Impaired Users	May struggle with low contrast text, color-only indicators, or small fonts
2. Users with Limited Motor Control	May find small buttons or tight tap areas difficult to interact with
3. Neurodivergent or Elderly Users	May be overwhelmed by visual clutter, unclear icons, or inconsistent layouts

Accessibility Principles Applied

- WCAG 2.1 contrast ratio (minimum 4.5:1 for text)
- Minimum 44×44px touch targets
- Use of text labels with icons
- Avoiding color-only visual indicators
- Clear text hierarchy and generous spacing
- Alternative text (ARIA labels) for screen readers

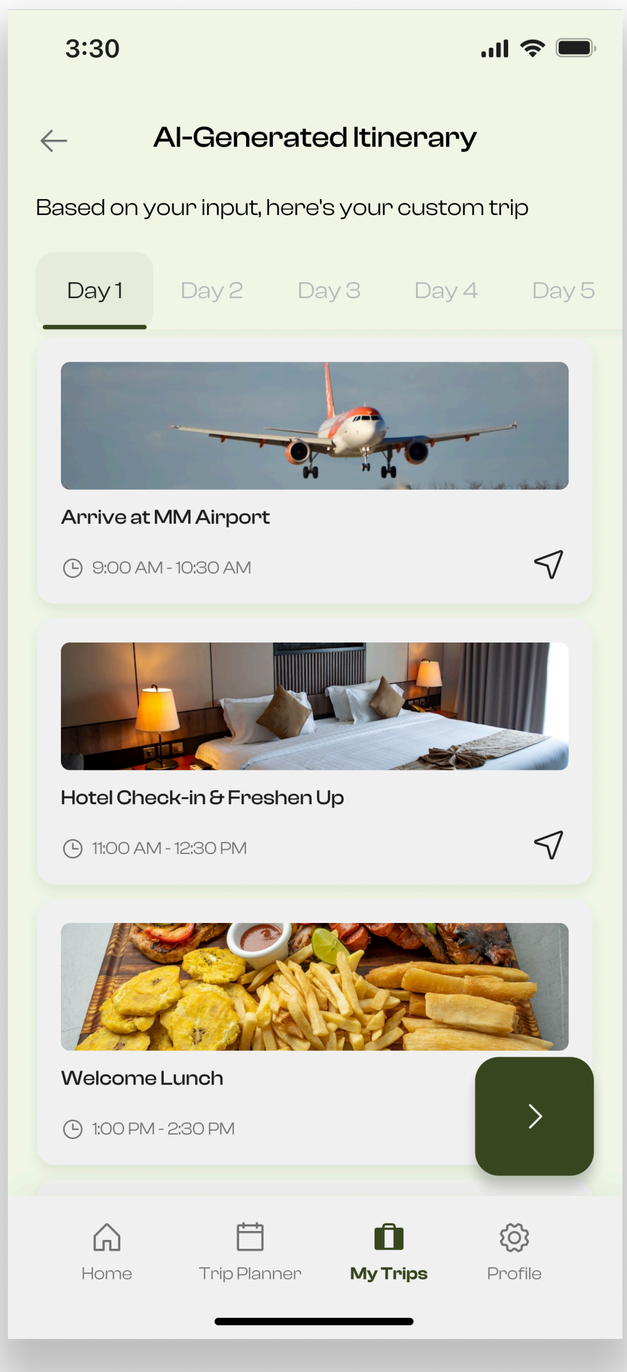
2. Evaluation of the Current UI

Screen Evaluated: AI-Generated Itinerary

The screen displays a list of itinerary events grouped by day, with real images, event names, and time slots.

Accessibility Issues Identified

Element	Problem Description
Tab Navigation (Day 1–5)	Uses color only to show selection; difficult for colorblind users
Time Labels	Text color is too light (#757575 on white), lacks contrast
CTA & Icon Buttons	Too small and lacks labels, not friendly for assistive tech users
Layout Spacing	Elements are close together; could overwhelm users with motor issues
Visual-only Indicators	Action cues (e.g., arrows) not accompanied by text or tooltips

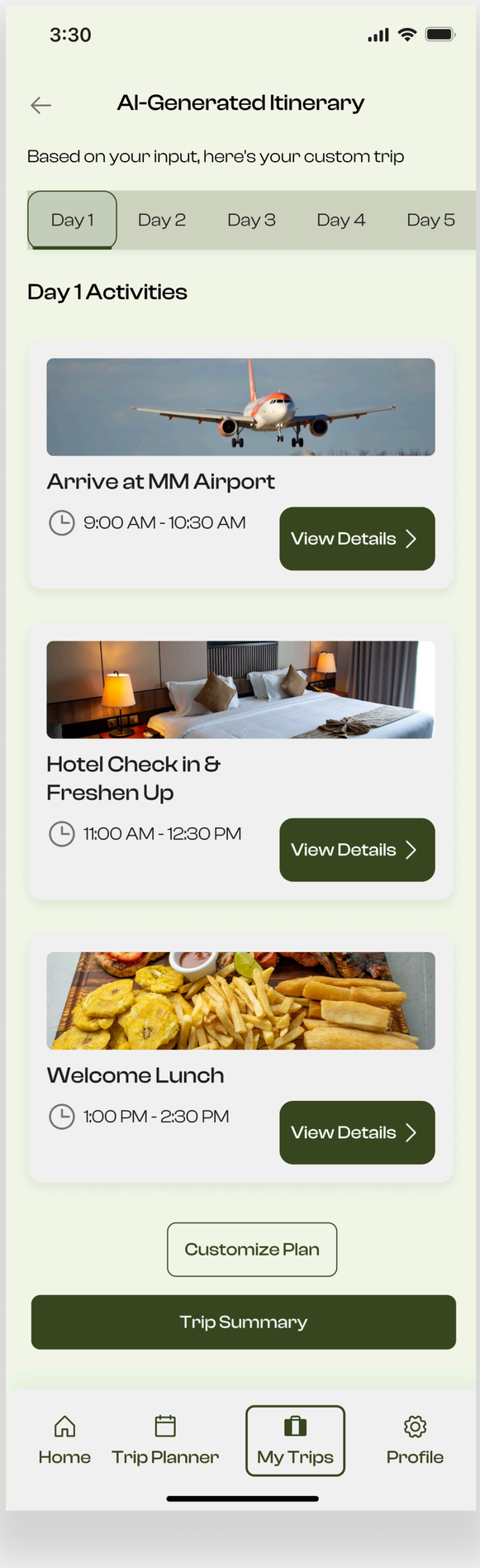


3: Redesigned UI with Inclusive Improvements

The redesigned AI-Generated Itinerary screen integrates the following inclusive features:

Key Inclusive Design Fixes

Element	Problem Description
Color-only active tab	Added bold underline + darker background and check icon for clarity
Low contrast placeholder text	Replaced with darker gray (#212121) text
Small icons & CTAs	Increased icon/button size to minimum 44×44px
Icons without labels	All icons now include supporting text or tooltips
Tight spacing	Increased vertical spacing between cards and sections



4. Reflection & Summary

Design Reflection

After evaluating the AI-Generated Itinerary screen, I implemented inclusive UI changes to support a wider range of users. The primary focus was on improving contrast, clarity, touch targets, and visual feedback.

Key decisions included replacing color-only indicators, increasing text contrast, and providing labels for all icons. These changes improve usability for people with low vision, motor limitations, or neurodivergence.

Moving forward, I will integrate accessibility plugins in Figma from the beginning of each project and ensure my components meet at least AA compliance. I also plan to add keyboard navigability and support for screen readers in future development phases.